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THE DOPAMINE AUDIT · YOUR FIRST FIX

Reset Your Baseline

Everything slow feels boring now. That is tolerance, not the world.

WHY THIS IS THE FIGHT

A constant drip of fast, high-novelty stimulation raises the bar for what registers as interesting. So a book, a walk, a real conversation start to feel flat, not because they got worse, but because your baseline crept up. That flatness is a tolerance, the same way a strong coffee habit makes a weak one do nothing.

HOW IT WORKS

Tolerance comes down the only way it ever does: by spending time below the line. You deliberately do less-stimulating things and let the boredom happen instead of reaching for a hit the second it shows up. Do that consistently and ordinary rewards start to land again. Boredom is not the problem here, it is the treatment.

THE FIXES

Stop stacking stimulation, one input at a time: no phone while you eat, walk, or watch something. Once a day, do one ordinary thing with no second screen and let it be boring on purpose. Then put back one slow, earned reward, a book, a training session, a walk with no headphones, a block of deep work, and protect it. If you can, take a half-day a week with screens kept to a minimum.

SEVEN DAYS

Print this. Run the fix for a week. Circle Y or N each day, one column per day. One honest week tells you more than a month of good intentions.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Did one thing today with zero second screen	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N
Sat with boredom without reaching for a hit	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N	Y/N

THE EVENING CHECK

Each night: what slow thing did you do, and how did it feel by the end compared to the start?

The feed will take whatever you give it. Decide what you won't.

This is the fix for the pattern your audit flagged as the tightest grip. Run it for a week before you add another. The other three are waiting when you are ready.